

ANSWER ENGINE OPTIMIZATION (AEO)

Assessment of capablewealth.com/blog

How well the blog and its posts are positioned to be cited by AI answer engines (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Gemini).

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Overall grade: C+ *promising strategy, early-stage execution*

Scope & method

What AEO is. Answer Engine Optimization is the practice of structuring content so AI assistants can extract, trust, and cite it when answering a user's question. It overlaps with SEO but rewards different things: direct answers, clear definitions, question-shaped headings, structured data, author credibility, and being referenced by other trusted sources.

What was reviewed. The homepage, the blog index, and metadata for every visible post were read in full. Individual post bodies intermittently failed to render during this review, so the in-post structure and schema findings are inferred from Squarespace platform defaults plus the index data, and are marked where relevant. These can be confirmed precisely with a live crawl of one or two posts.

Snapshot. The blog runs on Squarespace and appears recently rebuilt (2026 copyright, fresh asset IDs). It shows two eras of content: a focused, roughly weekly run of orthopedic-surgeon posts from Feb–May 2026, and a set of older, generic personal-finance posts from 2019.

Executive summary

The content strategy is genuinely well-suited to AEO. The blog occupies a narrow, defensible niche — financial, tax, and practice-exit planning for orthopedic surgeons — and AI engines preferentially cite sources that are unambiguously expert in a specific lane. The author identity and trust signals are strong.

The gap is execution and authority. The site is new, has little inbound authority, and is not yet surfacing for its own target topics. On-page, the posts likely lack the formatting AI engines reward most: answer-first summaries, question-shaped headings, definition blocks, and FAQ schema. A handful of high-value posts also use random URL slugs and calendar-bound titles that limit evergreen discoverability.

Bottom line: the hard part (a credible, focused content engine) is already in motion. The remaining work is mostly mechanical — formatting, schema, URLs — plus a sustained push on authority.

Grades by dimension

Dimension	Grade	Summary
Content & topical focus	A-	Tight orthopedic-surgeon niche, weekly cadence, expert author
Answer formatting	C	Excerpts are answer-led; in-post TL;DR / FAQ / definitions likely missing
Structured data (schema)	C	Squarespace adds basic Article schema; no FAQ/HowTo by default
On-page technical	C+	Good meta descriptions; some hash URLs; date-bound slugs
E-E-A-T / trust	B+	Named author, LinkedIn, podcast, media logos, 50+ reviews
Authority / citations	D	New domain; not surfacing for its own target topics yet
AI-discoverability files	D	No llms.txt; author entity not fully mapped

What's working

- **Narrow, defensible niche.** “Financial planning for orthopedic surgeons selling to private equity” is exactly the kind of specific lane AI engines like to attribute to a named expert.
- **Consistent cadence.** Roughly weekly publishing since late February 2026 builds topical depth and freshness signals.
- **Strong E-E-A-T.** A single named author (Jared Paul) with a LinkedIn profile, a podcast (The Ortho Money Show), “As Seen In” media logos, and 50+ Google reviews. AI models weight author and brand trust heavily.
- **Answer-oriented excerpts.** Post summaries read like direct answers and use concrete numbers, which is the right instinct for AEO.
- **Real topic clusters.** Categories group posts around tax, practice sales, retirement, and entity design, signalling subject-matter breadth within the niche.
- **Solid meta descriptions.** The homepage and blog index carry specific, benefit-led meta descriptions.

What's holding it back

1. **Low domain authority — and it shows.** Searches for the blog's own flagship topics (normalized EBITDA, personal goodwill, backdoor Roth for physicians) surface competitors (ECG, Sofer Advisors, Vestia, White Coat Investor) rather than Capable Wealth. AEO visibility lags authority; this needs active link-building, not just time.
2. **Clever titles, not query-matched.** Lines like “You're Not Overtaxed. You're Understructured.” work for humans but don't match how people or AIs phrase questions. The fix is question-shaped H2s inside posts, even when the title stays clever.
3. **Non-descriptive URLs on key posts.** The personal-goodwill and financial-second-opinion posts use random hash slugs. URLs are a relevance signal; these should be readable and keyword-bearing, with 301 redirects from the old paths.
4. **Likely missing the AEO formatting layer.** Squarespace generates basic Article schema but not FAQ or HowTo schema, and won't add TL;DR summaries or definition blocks on its own. These are the highest-leverage additions and are almost certainly absent.
5. **Calendar-bound posts.** Several titles/slugs are pinned to dates (“Opens April 16”, “Closes April 15”, “Before Q1 Closes”). Evergreen framing earns citations year-round; put the deadline in the body, not the URL.
6. **Legacy drag.** The 2019 posts (home down payments, real estate vs. stocks, skipping college) are off-niche and dilute topical focus. Prune, redirect, or re-home them.
7. **No AI-discoverability files.** No llms.txt and no dedicated author entity page to help AI systems map who is behind the content.

Per-post AEO scorecard

Ratings reflect how each post is positioned **as currently structured**. “AEO readiness” weighs topic value, query match, URL, and how citation-ready the format appears. The 2019 legacy posts are excluded from the table and addressed below.

Post	Date	URL	AEO readiness	Top AEO fix
Stop Planning Your Exit and Start Planning Your Next Chapter	5/18/26	Good	Weak	Lifestyle topic; add query H2s ('What do surgeons do after selling a practice?')
What “Normalized EBITDA” Really Means for Your Exit	5/11/26	Good	Moderate	High-value definitional topic; add FAQ schema + worked example
Personal Goodwill: The Tax Strategy for Your Practice Sale	5/4/26	Hash URL	Moderate	Rename slug; add definition block + FAQ; cite IRS/case law
Private Equity Is Calling. What They're Not Telling You	4/27/26	Good	Moderate	Flagship piece; add answer-first summary + FAQ; query-match H2s
The 5-Year Exit Timeline	4/20/26	Good	Moderate	Strong how-to; add HowTo/step structure + checklist
The Financial Second Opinion	4/13/26	Hash URL	Weak	Rename slug; sharpen to a searchable question
The Six-Month Window Opens April 16 (4 Moves)	4/6/26	Date-bound	Weak	Evergreen-ify title/slug; date in body not URL
The Backdoor Roth Window Closes April 15	3/30/26	Date-bound	Moderate	High-search topic; reframe to evergreen 'Backdoor Roth for high-income physicians'
Your Tax Return Is a Diagnostic Report	3/23/26	Good	Moderate	Add the 4 markers as scannable H2s + FAQ
Before Q1 Closes: The One Number That Matters	3/16/26	Date-bound	Weak	Evergreen-ify; lead with the metric definition
The 2.5% Cut Nobody's Talking About (CMS)	3/9/26	Good	Moderate	Timely/topical; add data points + source citations
The S-Corp Salary Trap	3/2/26	Good	Moderate	Strong query match; add FAQ + reasonable-comp definition
You're Not Overtaxed. You're Understructured.	2/23/26	Good	Moderate	Clever title; add plain H2s buyers search for

Legend — URL: “Good” = descriptive slug; “Hash URL” = random slug to rename; “Date-bound” = calendar-pinned slug. Readiness: Strong / Moderate / Weak.

Legacy 2019 posts (7+ visible): generic personal-finance topics off the orthopedic niche. Recommendation: keep only if refreshed and re-pointed to the surgeon audience; otherwise consolidate or noindex so they don't dilute topical authority.

Prioritized recommendations

Do first (high leverage, low effort)

8. **Add an answer-first summary** (2–3 sentence TL;DR or “key takeaways” box) at the top of every orthopedic post. This is the text most likely to be lifted into an AI answer.
9. **Add FAQ sections + FAQPage schema** to each post (3–5 question-shaped Q&As). Highest-leverage technical fix; template provided below.
10. **Rename hash URLs** to descriptive slugs (e.g., /personal-goodwill-practice-sale-tax) and 301-redirect the old paths.
11. **Insert query-matched H2s** and inline definitions for key terms (personal goodwill, normalized EBITDA, QBI, reasonable compensation).

Do next (build the moat)

12. **Cite authoritative primary sources** (IRS, CMS, relevant tax court cases). Outbound citations to trusted sources raise your own citation-worthiness and factual trust.
13. **Add statistics and worked examples** with specific numbers — AI engines preferentially quote concrete figures and step-by-step calculations.
14. **Strengthen the author entity**. A full author/bio page with credentials, plus consistent author schema, helps AI map the expertise behind the content.
15. **Cross-link the clusters**. Internally link related posts (exit-planning set, tax-structure set) to reinforce topical relationships.

Ongoing (authority)

16. **Convert media mentions and the podcast into backlinks**; pursue guest posts and mentions on physician-finance and orthopedic outlets. Authority is the single biggest unlock for AI visibility.
17. **Add an llms.txt** and keep the sitemap clean so AI crawlers can map the site.
18. **Evergreen-ify date-bound posts** and prune/refresh the 2019 legacy content.

Ready-to-paste: FAQ schema

Paste this into a Squarespace **Code Block** at the bottom of the post (or into Settings → Advanced → Code Injection for that page). Edit the questions/answers to match the post. Keep answers self-contained — each should make sense quoted on its own. Example shown for the Normalized EBITDA post.

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "FAQPage",
  "mainEntity": [
    {
      "@type": "Question",
      "name": "What is normalized EBITDA for a medical practice?",
      "acceptedAnswer": {
        "@type": "Answer",
        "text": "Normalized EBITDA is a practice\u2019s earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortization, adjusted to remove owner-specific items such as above-market owner pay, personal expenses run through the business, and one-time costs. Buyers use this adjusted figure\u2014not the number on your tax return\u2014to decide what an orthopedic practice is worth."
      }
    },
    {
      "@type": "Question",
      "name": "Why don\u2019t buyers value my practice off my tax return?",
      "acceptedAnswer": {
        "@type": "Answer",
        "text": "Tax returns are designed to minimize taxable income, so they understate true earning power. Buyers add back owner-discretionary and one-time items to estimate what the practice would earn under their ownership, then apply a multiple to that normalized EBITDA."
      }
    },
    {
      "@type": "Question",
      "name": "What add-backs increase normalized EBITDA?",
      "acceptedAnswer": {
        "@type": "Answer",
        "text": "Common add-backs include owner compensation above a market replacement salary, personal vehicles or travel, family payroll, one-time legal or buildout costs, and non-recurring equipment purchases. Each add-back must be documented and defensible to survive buyer due diligence."
      }
    }
  ]
}
</script>
```

Tip: validate the markup with Google's Rich Results Test and Schema.org validator before publishing.

Example post rewrite (target AEO format)

Below is the **Normalized EBITDA** post restructured into the format AI engines reward. It illustrates the pattern to apply across the catalogue: descriptive URL, answer-first summary, question-shaped H2s, an inline definition, a worked example with real numbers, and a closing FAQ. Treat the copy as a template to adapt, not final wording.

URL: /normalized-ebitda-orthopedic-practice-valuation

Title tag: Normalized EBITDA: How Buyers Really Value an Orthopedic Practice

Meta description: What normalized EBITDA means, why it differs from your tax return, and how add-backs change what a buyer will pay for your practice.

H1: What “Normalized EBITDA” Really Means for Your Practice Sale

Key takeaway: Buyers don't value your orthopedic practice off the profit on your tax return. They use normalized EBITDA — earnings adjusted for owner pay, personal expenses, and one-time costs — and apply a multiple to it. Understanding your add-backs before you negotiate can move the sale price by hundreds of thousands of dollars.

What is normalized EBITDA? (definition)

Normalized EBITDA is your practice's earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortization, adjusted to reflect what the business would earn under a new owner. The adjustments — called add-backs — strip out costs that are personal to you or one-time in nature, so the buyer sees the practice's true ongoing profitability.

Why doesn't my tax return show what my practice is worth?

Your tax return is engineered to minimize taxable income, so it deliberately understates earning power. A buyer reverses that: they add back owner-discretionary spending and non-recurring items to estimate normalized earnings, then apply an industry multiple to that figure.

Worked example: a \$2.4M orthopedic practice

Suppose the practice reports \$600K of pre-tax profit. A buyer normalizes it:

- Reported profit: \$600,000
- Add back owner pay above a \$400K market salary: +\$250,000
- Add back personal vehicle, travel, family payroll: +\$70,000
- Add back one-time EHR migration cost: +\$40,000
- **Normalized EBITDA: \$960,000**

At a 5x multiple, the difference between valuing the reported \$600K and the normalized \$960K is roughly \$1.8M in enterprise value — which is why documenting defensible add-backs early matters.

Which add-backs hold up in due diligence?

Add-backs must be documented and defensible. Above-market owner compensation, clearly personal expenses, and genuinely one-time costs typically survive. Vague or undocumented adjustments get stripped out — and can erode buyer trust in the rest of your numbers.

Frequently asked questions

Is EBITDA the same as cash flow? No. EBITDA ignores capital expenditures, working-capital changes, and debt service, so it overstates cash available to an owner. Buyers still anchor on it because it normalizes across practices.

What EBITDA multiple do orthopedic practices sell for? Multiples vary with size, payer mix, and buyer type; larger, lower-risk practices command higher multiples. Use a range from comparable transactions rather than a single number.

When should I start normalizing my numbers? Ideally several years before a sale, so add-backs are documented and the practice's reported financials trend toward its true earning power.

CTA block: “Thinking about a sale in the next 5 years? Get a normalized-EBITDA review before you talk to buyers.” + booking link.

Then append the FAQPage schema block from the previous page (questions matched to the FAQ section above).

Suggested next steps

19. Apply the four “do first” fixes to the top 5 orthopedic posts as a pilot, starting with the Normalized EBITDA and Personal Goodwill posts.
20. Rename the two hash-slug URLs and set 301 redirects.
21. Stand up an author page and add lms.txt.
22. Begin an authority push: backlinks from the podcast, media placements, and physician-finance outlets.
23. Re-measure in 60–90 days by checking whether the blog is cited in AI answers for its target questions.